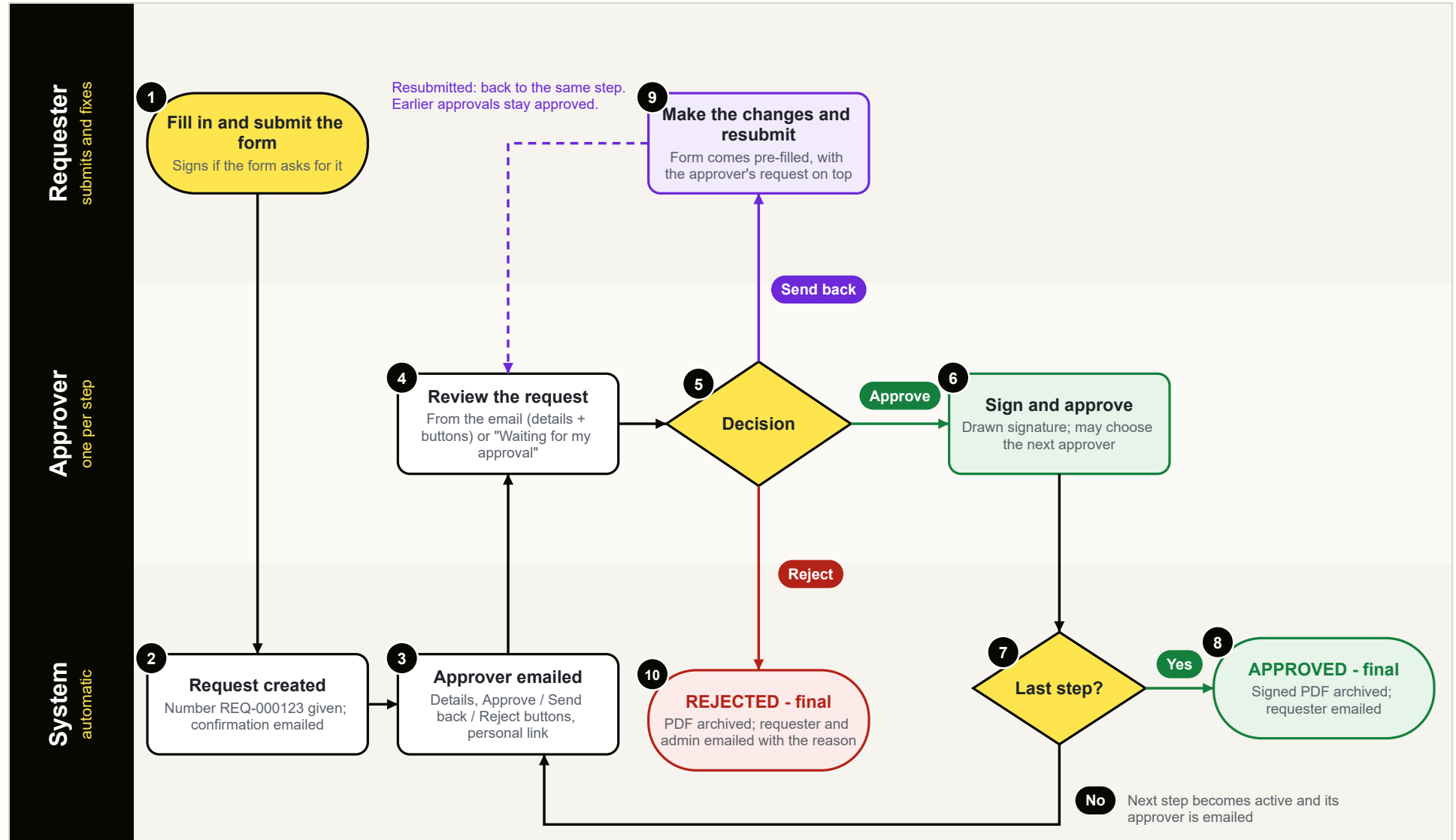


ApprovalFlow | Request workflow

How a request moves from submission to a final, signed and archived decision.



While a step waits

Reminders and escalation run on the step's own rules. An administrator can remind, reassign, add a delegate or cancel the request.

Signatures and records

Every approval needs a drawn signature. The final PDF carries the submission, each decision and signature, any send-backs, and the audit trail.

Final means final

Approved, Rejected and Cancelled requests cannot be changed. To fix a request, send it back; to try again after a rejection, submit a new one.

Step by step

Each number matches a box on the workflow diagram (page 1).

#	Step	Who	What happens	Emails sent
1	Fill in and submit the form	Requester	Opens the form from the home page (Start a new request) and fills it in; fields marked * are required. Signs in the signature box if the form has one. On some forms, chooses who approves first in the Send to box. Chooses Submit for approval. If anything is missing or wrong, the fields are highlighted and nothing is sent.	-
2	Request created	System	Gives the request its number (for example REQ-000123) and the status In progress, saves exactly what was submitted, and makes step 1 active. The requester sees the request page with its progress tracker.	Requester: "We received your request"
3	Approver emailed	System	Emails the step's approver (and any delegate) a personal link that works only for their account and expires after 14 days. The email lists the request details (up to 12 fields, unless the organisation turned this off) and has Approve, Send back and Reject buttons. Reminders and escalation follow the step's rules while it waits.	Approver: "Approval needed"; later "Reminder" if set up
4	Review the request	Approver	Signs in (from the email or the home page list "Waiting for my approval"). Sees the full submission, every earlier step's decision, comments, signature and documents, and any earlier send-backs. Never sees later steps. Nothing can be edited.	-
5	Decision	Approver	Chooses one of three: Approve (go to 6), Send back for changes (go to 9) or Reject (go to 10). A button pressed in the email opens the page ready for that choice; the approver still confirms on the page.	-
6	Sign and approve	Approver	Draws a signature (required to approve). May add comments and attach documents. If the step asks for it, chooses who approves the next step. The decision, time and signature are recorded and can no longer be changed.	-
7	Last step?	System	No: the next step becomes active and its approver is emailed (back to 3 for that approver). Yes: the request is fully approved (go to 8).	Next approver: "Approval needed"
8	APPROVED - final	System	Status Approved; nothing can change it. A signed PDF (submission, every decision and signature, any send-backs, audit summary) is created within a minute and archived. The requester and the approvers can download it.	Requester: "Your request is fully approved"
9	Make the changes and resubmit	Requester	The approver wrote what needs to change (required). The request stays In progress, marked Sent back. The requester chooses Make the changes: the form opens pre-filled with the approver's message on top; drawn signatures must be made again; a note can be added. Resubmit sends it straight back to the same step (back to 3). Earlier approvals stay approved. Can happen more than once.	Requester: "Changes needed"; approver on resubmit: "Resubmitted for approval" with what changed
10	REJECTED - final	System	The approver gave a reason (required). The request stops: later steps are marked Not reached, and it can never be reopened. A PDF marked REJECTED is archived. To try again, the requester starts a new request using the same details.	Requester: "Your request was rejected" with the reason; administrators: alert

At any time while a request is open - administrators

Send reminder (a fresh link to the current approver) - Reassign a step to someone else, or add a delegate who can act too - Cancel the request with a reason (final, the requester is emailed, no PDF).
Every submission, decision, email, download and change is recorded in the audit log with the user and time.